Music in Western Civilization

Topic 6.1 – Romanticism
浪漫主义
music & poetry
German ***Lieder*** 德语艺术歌曲

Professor Chan Wing Wah
陈永华教授
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The Origin of Romanticism

1810-1910



Medieval Romance:

1. heroic stories written in Latin or Roman languages on the adventure of the knights;
2. epic poetry from the Northern countries.
3. can be legend and reworked stories, e.g. *King Arthur, Beowolf*, etc.

After the Medieval, Renaissance, Baroque and Classical Periods, the ***19th century Romanticism*** came as a movement to *get rid of all constraints* and developed one's ***individuality*** through the revival of the ideals in literature, art, music & philosophy.

The Essence of 19th century Romanticism

- Strangeness, remoteness, boundlessness, **freedom**;
- Legendary, emotional, passionate, poetic, imaginary;
- Symbolic & individualistic,
- Not limited to love towards a person, but *love towards life* and *the struggle to achieve*,
- ***endless pursuit of the unattainable;***
- Romanticism is thus a movement against the control of Classical symmetry, formality and order.
- It also receives inspiration from Francis Bacon's (1561-1626) claim that : "*there is no excellent beauty that hath not some strangeness in the proportion*."



Wanderer above the Sea of Fog, also known as Wanderer above the Mist, oil painting c. 1818 by the German Romantic artist Caspar David Friedrich



Eugène Delacroix – La Liberté guidant le peuple (Liberty Leading the People) on French Revolution of 1830

The Romanticists

Poets: *William Blake*布萊克, *Lord Byron*拜倫, *John Keats*濟慈;

Writers: *Goethe*歌德, *Victor Hugo*雨果,

*Alexandre Dumas*大仲马, *Balzac*巴尔扎克;

Artists: *Goya, J.M.W. Turner, Eugène Delacroix*

Bartley, Robert: *Mao: The Romantic Revolutionary*.

The Wall Street Journal, 20th Oct.,1976

Wang, Ban : *Chap.30 : Revolutionary Realism and Revolutionary Romanticism*.

The Columbia Companion to Modern Chinese Literature. Jan., 2016.

Reardon, B.M.G.: *The Romanticism of Karl Marx*

Research Article, SAGE Journals. Jan., 1978

What is poetry?

"To see a world in
a grain of sand
And heaven in a
wild flower,
Hold infinity in
the palm of your
hand
And eternity in an
hour."

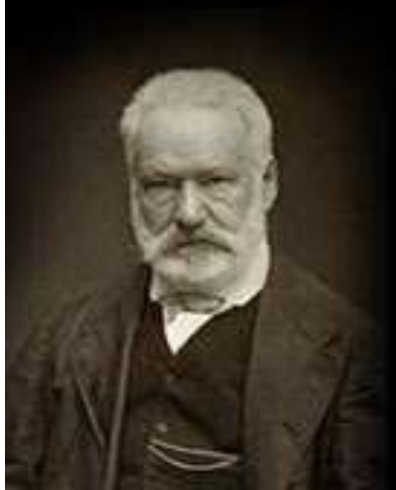
- William Blake



I almost wish we were
butterflies and lived but
three summer days --
three such days with you I
could fill with more delight
than fifty common years
could ever contain.

- John Keats

Music expresses that which cannot be said and on which it is impossible to be silent.



Victor Hugo

French Poet

(1802-1885)

QuoteHD.com

Romanticism in **Music**

Free *rhythm*, *non-symmetrical phrases*, unending *melodies*, chromatic *harmony* with non-harmonic tones, freer *form*, larger orchestra thus more varieties of tone *colour*, *poetic and lyrical*, *programmatic* music/symphonic poem.

In a simpler language: *individualistic*, illusionary, *fast changing* of tempo and dynamics: fast/slow, loud/soft, fast changing mood, sentimental and sensational.

German Lied (art song) 德国艺术歌曲

plural: Lieder (songs)

- 19th-century German art song characterized by the setting of a poetic text in either strophic or through-composed style, the treatment of the piano and voice in equal artistic partnership.

  Dictionary.com

- *Although the term was used as early as 12th century, it generally refers to songs set to German poetry in the Romantic Period.*

Franz Schubert 舒伯特 1797-1828

born & died in Vienna

Over 600 **Lieder**, 9 Symphonies, string quartets, quintets, sonatas, Masses, etc.

Ave Maria 圣母颂 D.839

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cqoP8rkNIsY Sumi Jo. sung in German, for her father.

http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=do5ZmQQM8AE Jesse Norman. sung in German

Ständchen (Serenade) 小夜曲 D 920

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cBPDCLi70cE Fischer-Dieskau (baritone). sung in German

Die Forelle (The Trout) 鳟鱼 D.550

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NF9DrUXowBo Fischer-Dieskau (baritone) , English surtitles

An die Musik (To Music) 音乐颂 D.547

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NeGdjJfVMzU Wunderlich (tenor)

Song Cylce 联篇歌曲 : a group of songs

Die schöne Müllerin (The Beautiful Miller's Maid) 美丽的磨坊少女, Op. 25, (D. 795),
20 Poems by Wilhelm Müller
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z148EfPmk3A Fischer-Dieskau

Winterreise (A Winter's Journey) 冬之旅（D.911）
24 Poems by Wilhelm Müller:
No. 5 *Der Lindenbaum (Linden Tree)* 菩提树
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jyxMMg6bxrg Fischer-Dieskau
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TwUSBw5SFmg Liao Changyong, (note the Bösendorfer piano)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8vECU4Fs9GM&t=64s齿轮传声合唱团 Taipei

Winterreise: Der Lindenbaum

Wilhelm Müller	Richard Wigmore transl.
Am Brunnen vor dem Tore,	By the well, before the gate,
Da steht ein Lindenbaum;	stands a linden tree;
Ich träumt' in seinem Schatten	in its shade I dreamt
So manchen süssen Traum.	many a sweet dream.
Ich schnitt in seine Rinde	In its bark I carved
So manches liebe Wort;	many a word of love;
Es zog in Freud' und Leide	in joy and sorrow
Zu ihm mich immer fort.	I was ever drawn to it.

German Romanticism

Medieval : religious art, mosaic, folklore, Romanesque and gothic churches

Renaissance : art(painting, sculpture), literature, natural science.
Baroque : art, grand architecture, decorative art(rococo)

Classicism : philosophy, aristocratic life, dances.

Romanticism: literature(poetry, novel), philosophy

From church to noble family -

Through French Revolution to the common people.

Public concerts

Free education such as university

Robert Schumann 舒曼1810-1856

- **Frauenliebe und Leben** (Women's Love & Life), Op.42 (8 Poems by von Chamisso):
- *No.1: Seit ich ihn gesehen* (Since I saw his face), Elly Ameling http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M0calarKrRM

Myrthen (Myrtles) Op. 25: 26 songs for voice & piano.

- *No.1: Widmung* (Dedication), text: Friedrich Rückert http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pOk1OzwGnUk Schwarzkopf

- Dedicated to his wife Clara as a wedding gift. It was arranged for solo piano by Liszt. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-5_jzx1mPLA

No. 1 : Since I Saw His Face (Seit ich ihn gesehen)

Chamisso

Since I set eyes on him
I think that I've gone blind;
Wherever it is I look
It's only him I find;
As in a waking dream
His image, there before me,
Stands out against the darkness,
Bright, and oh, so clearly.
There is no light or colour
Now in my surroundings,
I have no wish to join
My sisters with their playthings;
I would far rather go and weep
Quietly in my room –
I think that I've gone blind
Since I set eyes on him.

Widmung

German

Du meine Seele, du mein Herz,
Du meine Wonn', O du mein Schmerz,
Du meine Welt, in der ich lebe,
Mein Himmel du, darein ich schwebe,
O du mein Grab, in das hinab
Ich ewig meinen Kummer gab.

Du bist die Ruh, du bist der Frieden,
Du bist vom Himmel mir beschieden.
Daß du mich liebst, macht mich mir wert,
Dein Blick hat mich vor mir verklärt,
Du hebst mich liebend über mich,
Mein guter Geist, mein beßres Ich!

Dedication

English translation

You my soul, you my heart,
you my bliss, o you my pain,
you the world in which I live;
you my heaven, in which I float,
o you my grave, into which
I eternally cast my grief.

You are rest, you are peace,
you are bestowed upon me from heaven.
That you love me makes me worthy of
you;
your gaze transfigures me;
you raise me lovingly above myself,
my good spirit, my better self!

Johannes Brahms 布拉姆斯 1833-1897

- Wiegenlied (Cradle Song) Op.49, N0.4
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ga0mBWIF6Jw
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BBJpI2LGDjk Sumi Jo, unaccompanied





Romanticism is beauty without bounds-the beautiful infinite.

– Jean Paul

AZ QUOTES

I will not reason and compare: my business is to create.

- William Blake

